

Civil Services (Main) Qualifying English - Paper B

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 300

INSTRUCTIONS

1. All questions are compulsory except that only one essay topic is to be attempted.
2. Write all answers in English and observe the indicated word limits.
3. Marks in this qualifying paper are not counted for merit ranking.

Q1. Essay [100 marks]

Write about 600 words on any one topic.

1. Resilience is built before a crisis becomes visible.
2. Good communication makes authority more accountable.
3. A society that cannot correct error cannot preserve knowledge.
4. Shared spaces teach the practical meaning of equality.

Q2. Comprehension [75 marks]

Preparedness is frequently judged by the existence of a plan. A document is necessary, but it cannot prove that people know their roles, equipment works or warnings reach those at risk. Real preparedness is a chain whose weakest link may determine the result. Forecasting is of little value if the message is delayed; a timely warning fails if it is not understood; an evacuation order fails when transport, shelters or trust are absent. Exercises expose these gaps before an emergency, provided they test realistic pressure rather than demonstrate a prearranged success. Local knowledge is equally important because residents know which road floods first, who needs assistance and which message will be trusted. Central coordination can supply standards and resources, but it should not silence local information. After an event, review must identify system failures without becoming a search for a convenient individual to blame. Preparedness improves when institutions convert experience into revised procedures, budgets, training and public communication.

1. Why is the existence of a plan insufficient evidence of preparedness?
2. Explain the chain character of preparedness.
3. What makes an exercise useful?
4. How should central coordination and local knowledge relate?
5. What is the purpose of post-event review?

Q3. Precis Writing [75 marks]

Write a precis in about one-third of the passage. Do not give a title.

Correction is often experienced as embarrassment because it admits that an earlier judgment was incomplete or wrong. Institutions may therefore defend a decision long after evidence has changed. This protects short-term reputation but increases long-term damage. A correction system should distinguish honest revision from negligence. People should be accountable for ignoring available evidence, concealing mistakes or repeating avoidable errors; they should not be punished merely for revising a reasonable conclusion when new facts emerge. Records make this distinction possible by showing what was known, why a choice was made and when contrary evidence appeared. Correction also requires communication. Quietly changing a rule may stop future harm but leaves affected people without remedy and allows false information to persist. A responsible institution states what changed, repairs consequences where possible and explains how recurrence will be prevented. The capacity to correct is thus not evidence of weakness. It is a discipline that preserves trust by making authority answerable to reality.

Q4. Usage and Vocabulary [50 marks]

A. Correct the sentences

1. The quality of these roads have improved.
2. He ordered for a fresh inquiry.
3. She did not knew the rule.
4. The equipment were tested.
5. No sooner did he arrive when it rained.

B. Supply the missing preposition or word

1. adhere ____
2. entrust ____
3. protect ____
4. depend ____
5. object ____

C. Use the correct verb form

1. By tomorrow, I ____ (finish) the draft.
2. Unless he ____ (apologise), they will leave.
3. The bridge ____ (repair) last year.
4. She ____ (write) when the lights failed.
5. We ____ (know) them for a decade.

D. Choose the correct word

1. adapt/adopt
2. precede/proceed
3. personal/personnel
4. cite/site
5. eminent/imminent

END OF PAPER